EAST LANE THEATRE

Marketing Strategy

Primary Goal

Within 6 months, increase ticket sales for 18–30-year-olds by 20% through social media marketing and the introduction of a student discount.

Social Media Metric Goals

Instagram 500
TikTok 500
Facebook 300

Initial Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
- Long history - Good reputation - Community based - High quality amateur productions - Affordable tickets - Loyal customer base - Variety of productions - Easy access with public transport and own vehicles	- Website could be modernised and optimised for mobile devices without losing authenticity - Limited social media presence with infrequent posts - Basic visual branding and graphic design - Marketing mainly uses traditional methods - Limited marketing budget - Limited awareness, especially with young people
Opportunities	**Threats**
- Increase presence on Instagram, TikTok and Facebook - Target students in Wembley and local universities - Employ student discounts - Encourage audience to share on social media - Improve website - Offer a local influencer a free ticket to come to the show - Call To Action for attendees to leave reviews and spread the word	- Competition from other theatres - Who have a stronger online presence - Competition from concerts, cinemas, streaming platforms etc. - Rising costs - Cost-of-living pressures reducing spending on entertainment - Ageing audience - Productions mainly target older audiences - Limited funding

East Lane already has...

- Committed volunteers
- Community
- A great history
- Talented performers
- Affordable tickets

Research

Research shows	Why this matters for East Lane	How this affects marketing strategies
2025 saw a 4% increase in attendance since 2019	Demonstrates increasing demand for live theatre and the potential to attract new audiences	There is an active audience to target
Nationally, most theatre tickets were sold for £39.50 or less	East Lane tickets are half this price, making them very affordable	Promote affordability as a key selling point, specifically targeting students (through a student discount), families and locals
Rising costs across the theatre industry as a whole	East Lane Theatre depends on ticket sales and audience support to remain operational	Focus on retaining existing customers, repeat attendance and loyalty through email marketing and social media
Most West End audiences are 45 and older	Aligns with East Lane's current audience demographic which could limit future growth	Focus on attracting younger audiences whilst maintaining a connection with existing customers
84.3% are more likely to be influenced by positive word-of-mouth	East Lane already has a loyal audience	Encourage reviews, photos and social media content
74.3% are more likely to book when descriptions are clear	Posters and website provide very limited information about productions	Improve website with full synopses, production images and calls to action
68.1% are more likely to book if they are familiar with the play	Vicar of Dibley attracted more attendees than Nevill's Island. Programming impacts the marketability of productions.	Show recognisable plays or employ stronger campaigns with more information about the show
78% of theatre attendees under 35 use social media as their main source of information	East Lane has a notable absence on social media and low awareness among younger age groups	Increase social media presence and target Wembley students specifically
Creative artwork is a major marketing strategy and helps shows become recognisable	Posters and branding are inconsistent and unengaging	Improve visual branding with more recognisable images used consistently across social media, posters, and the website.
Emotions are central to theatre marketing	People buy theatre tickets for the experience	Use storytelling, rehearsal clips, and behind-the-scenes content

CORE PRINCIPLES

1. East Lane Theatre Brand

Aim to build long-term relationships and loyalty

- Develop a consistent visual identity
- Consistent logo placement
- Stick to 3 or 4 colours and 2 fonts
- Similar visual style across posters, website, and social media

2. Storytelling

People buy tickets because they feel connected

- Content could include:
  - Rehearsal Footage
  - Backstage Videos
  - Cast Interviews
  - Director Interviews
  - Costume Making
  - Set Building
  - Audience Response

3. Community

Reinforce East Lane's identity as a community theatre

- Understand and know the audience
- Content could include:
  - Interviewing regular audience members
  - History of the theatre
  - Former performers
  - Introducing everyone involved

BIG IDEAS

Behind East Lane Theatre

Introduce the people behind East Lane Theatre

- Interview the primary people
- Professional multi-camera filming
- Tell the story of East Lane
- Show why the theatre is important
- These will then become:
  - YouTube videos
  - Instagram Reels / TikToks
  - Facebook posts

History Series

Highlight East Lane's history

- Did you know?
- Then vs Now
- Archive photos
- Old photos with Gen-Z captions

Meet the Volunteers

The heart of East Lane

- Who they are
- What they do
- Why they volunteer
- What East Lane means to them
- Memories

Micro-Influencers

A recommendation rather than an advertisement

- Students and local lifestyle creators
- Offer them complimentary tickets and a backstage tour
- They should create social media content and reviews as a minimum

POSTS – specific

To Entertain

- Rehearsals
- Set building
- Costumes
- Tech rehearsal
- Dress rehearsal
- “Meet the cast in 10 seconds”
- Transformation reels
- POVs
- Stage bows
- Poll: “Tech or Dress Rehearsal?”
- Question sticker: “Ask our cast”

To Educate

- Volunteer introductions
- 3 myths we hear all the time
- Why theatre traditions exist
- “What actually happens during intermission?”

To Inspire (and CTA)

- Cast spotlights
- Audience reviews
- Volunteer stories
- Opening night reactions
- Countdown to opening night
- “Book your tickets” posts
- Student discount reminders

PRIORITIES – short-term

NOW

- Photograph and film as much as possible

Establish a Consistent Online Presence

- Post 3 times per week on Instagram and Facebook
- Consist of 1 Entertain, 1 Educate, and 1 Inspire (CTA)
- Use stories for rehearsals and show week

Build a Content Library

- Photograph every rehearsal and production
- Record interviews
- Create a google drive

Improve branding consistency

- Use 2 fonts
- Use 3 or 4 colours
- Use similar templates
- Same logo position
- Recognisable graphic design for each production

Fonts:

C E N T U R Y G O T H I C (expanded)

Georgia

Garamond

Aptos

Colours:

